Interestingly, all sorts of theories were being floated in western nations about how COVID-19 infections could be treated—many of them far from scientific. For instance, President Trump was touting the use of disinfectant inside the human body as a COVID-19 cure. An eyewitness reported at the time,

> Let me set the scene, the President had brought along an official for whom this was his first outing in the Briefing Room. At the Department of Homeland Security in their research labs they have been conducting a study on the impact of UV light, temperature and humidity on the coronavirus. And the findings were really interesting—and encouraging. The warmer it gets, the brighter it is, the more humid it is, the less long the virus lives on the surfaces or in the air. The DHS boffin then took us through the impact that [the] disinfectant had on the virus—how it killed it stone dead within a very short time. This clearly flicks a switch in the President's head—and very quickly it is open mic night at Trump University medical school, junior common room. He is riffing on what the potential of this might be. The President starts speculating on putting UV lamps inside the human body. My head is spinning. But then he muses on whether you could inject disinfectant into the human body, just like you spray it onto a kitchen surface: 'I see the disinfectant that knocks it out in a minute, one minute. And is there a way we can do something like that by injection inside, or almost a cleaning? Because you see it gets inside the lungs and it does a tremendous number on the lungs, so it would be interesting to check that.'[31]

Meanwhile, India was focused on strengthening its team of scientists advising the prime minister and the government so that our responses were absolutely, positively evidence-based. In furtherance to that resolve, an important development by mid-April was the constitution of the 'Task Force for Focused Research on Corona Vaccine and other Science & Technology issues' (Vaccine Task Force or VTF, as members would refer to it) with Dr Paul and Prof. VijayRaghavan as co-chairs.[32] This body subsumed the R&D Task Force on COVID-19 research which was formed a month ago and expanded its membership to now include secretaries of Health Research, Biotechnology, Science and Technology, Scientific and Industrial Research, Telecom, Electronics and Information Technology,